

- A cloud workspace can also be a unified platform that allows an organisation to monitor multiple projects across different accounts, and even different cloud providers, all in one location.

To facilitate a smooth transition to a robust cloud workspace environment, IT teams should focus on the activities across five phases, as listed in Table 1.

Microsoft workspace offerings

Microsoft offers two cloud workspace models:

- Azure Virtual Desktop, which is optimised for flexibility
- Windows 365, which is optimised

for simplicity

Azure Virtual Desktop (formerly known as Windows Virtual Desktop) is a flexible cloud virtual desktop infrastructure (VDI) platform that securely delivers virtual desktops and remote apps. Enterprises can use it to set up a scalable and flexible environment:

- Create a full desktop virtualisation environment in your Azure subscription without running any gateway servers.
- Publish host pools as you need to accommodate diverse workloads.
- Bring your own image for production workloads or tests from the Azure Gallery.

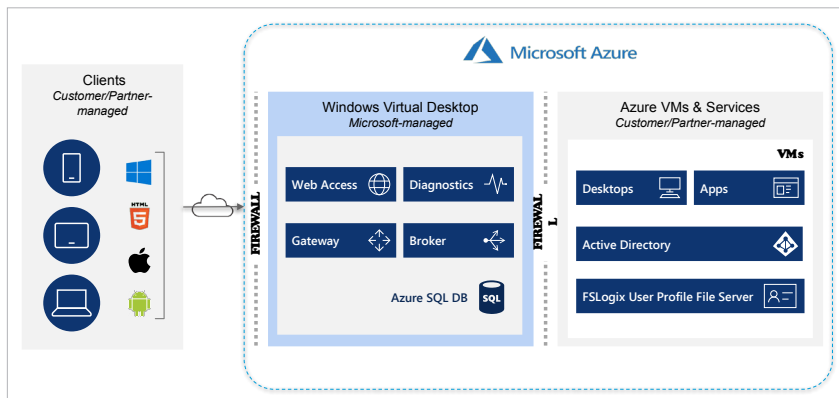


Figure 1: Azure Virtual Desktop

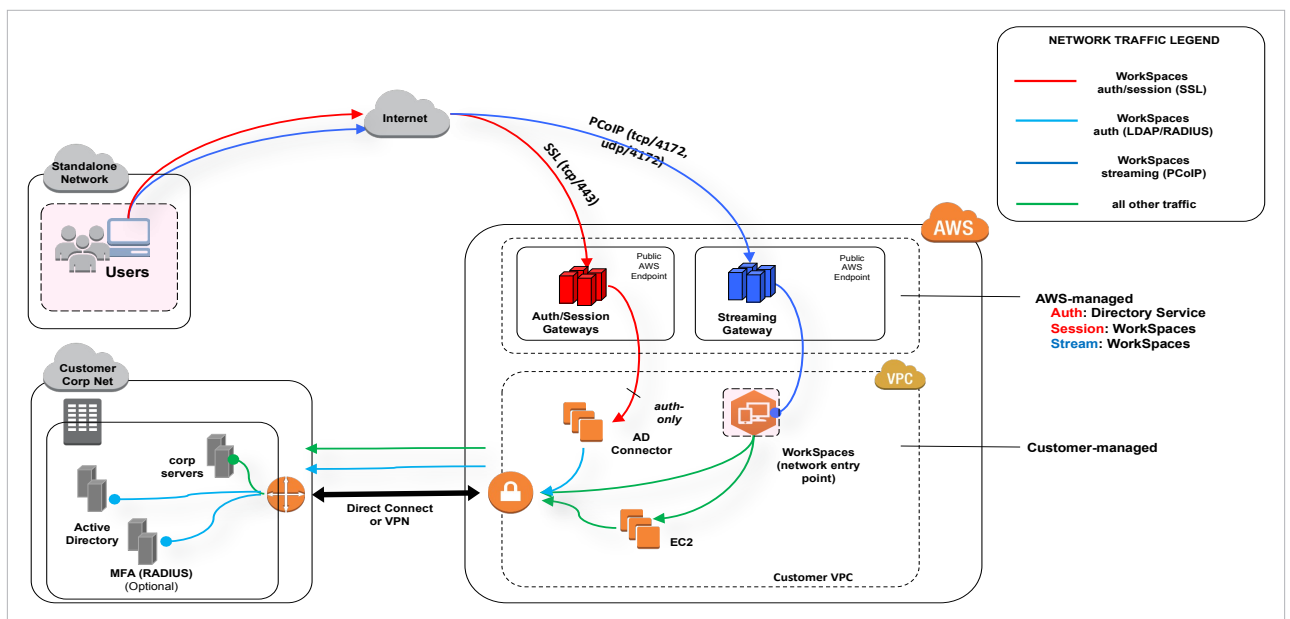


Figure 2: AWS WorkSpaces architecture

- Reduce costs with pooled, multi-session resources. With the new Windows 11 and Windows 10 Enterprise multi-session capability, exclusive to Azure Virtual Desktop and remote desktop session host (RDSH) roles on Windows Server, you can greatly reduce the number of virtual machines and operating system overhead while still providing the same resources to your users.
- Provide individual ownership through personal (persistent) desktops.
- Use an auto scale to automatically increase or decrease capacity based on time of day, specific days of the week, or as demand changes, thus helping to manage cost.
- Provide full control over management and deployment, plus options for Citrix and VMware integration.

Windows 365 is a complete software-as-a-service (SaaS) solution that securely streams your personalised Windows experience – all your apps, content and settings – to any device.

It offers:

- Windows 10 and Windows 11 personalised desktops